

THE POSY ACADEMY

The No-Pressure Guide to Going Live

Everything I wish someone had told me
before my first live -- from a former teacher
who's now a full-time streamer.

*a handpicked set of tools for creators
who'd rather be living than working*

by Brooke Co

This isn't a performance guide

A year ago I was a full-time public school teacher. I decided to go live on TikTok for the first time on a whim. A year later, I'm a full-time live streamer -- completely self-employed, working on my own schedule, and making more money than I ever did in a classroom.

This guide is everything I wish someone had told me before that first live.

LESSON 1

The 7-Live Tax

Think of your first 7 lives as paying a tax. You're not trying to hit sales numbers. You're not performing. You're practicing.

You're learning the platform, getting comfortable hearing yourself talk, figuring out the flow of a live, and building a skill that will make you money for a long time -- but not necessarily today.

If you don't sell a single thing in those first 7 lives, that's fine. That was never the point. The point is reps. Every live you do makes the next one easier.

Not selling something could be a product issue, but if you're brand new to lives, skill-building matters more than any sales number right now.

LESSON 2

Go faceless (if you need to)

This one is optional. If you can push past the discomfort and show your face from day one, do it. People want to connect with you and they connect with your face. You don't have to be faceless to see success with live streams.

But if the thought of being on camera and talking fluently about a product at the same time feels like too much -- go faceless.

Point your camera at the product. Make sure your hand or a pointer is visible and making movement toward what you're showing (you need movement on screen or you can get a violation).

TIP

When you're faceless, you can pull up your script on your laptop or print it out and read it word-for-word. Nobody can see you reading. Is it going to sound polished and pretty? No. But that's not the point. You're getting familiar with the product, the platform, and the act of talking to an audience.

When you're ready, graduate to having your face on screen with your script off to the side. Then bullet points instead of a full script. Then eventually you won't need notes at all.

LESSON 3

Choose a product you actually connect with

Don't pick a product just because the commission is good or because it's trending. If you have no personal connection to it, it's not going to convert.

The lives where I found success quickly were the ones where I chose a product that was extremely personal to me and I could tell my real story about it. That's what people respond to -- not a polished pitch, but a real person who actually uses and believes in what they're selling.

100% be yourself. People appreciate real and raw and authenticity. That's your edge.

LESSON 4

Aim for 90 minutes

I know. That sounds like a lot. And it can be extremely painful when traffic is low and sales aren't happening.

But the algorithm rewards consistency and time. The longer you stay on, the more you're proving to TikTok that you're a serious creator. Many people see better results the longer they go because you're showing the algorithm you can stick it out -- and ideally if you can get at least a couple sales before you end, you're proving you can convert.

If you only go live for 30 minutes at a time and never make sales in that window and just hop off, you're literally telling TikTok: I only go live for 30 minutes and I don't make sales. So they stop sending you traffic.

TIP

The pause button trick: If you hit a wall -- 45 minutes in, no traffic, no sales, eyes glazing over -- hit pause. Stand up. Walk away. Get a drink. Go to the bathroom. When you come back and hit play, it's almost like a reset. Even if the second half doesn't bring sales either, you made it through. And that matters.

LESSON 5

Don't watch the room count

The number of people in your live at any given moment means nothing. Don't look at it.

It will mess with your head. You'll see 2 people and think nobody cares. You'll see 50 and freeze up. Neither reaction helps you.

The number you should look at instead: average time watched.

Your live dashboard shows this -- it might say 5 seconds, 20 seconds, or if you're doing well, a minute.

Here's why that number matters: when you feel like you've been saying the same thing over and over for 30 minutes and everyone must think you're crazy -- look at the average watch time. If it's 20 seconds, the people watching you right now are completely different from the people who were watching 30 seconds ago.

TIP

It's OK to repeat yourself. Your audience is constantly rotating. What feels repetitive to you is brand new to them.

LESSON 6

Don't watch other streamers. Or do.

This one depends on you -- and it might be different every single day.

If watching other people's lives gives you inspiration, if you can pick up tips on setup or product talk or flow and use that as motivation -- watch. Learn from it. Let it fuel you.

But if it gets in your head -- if you see their room count, how fast they convert, their setup, their energy, and you walk away feeling worse about yourself -- stop. Close the app. Don't watch.

Listen to your internal self-talk. If you're watching someone else's live and your brain is saying "I could never do that" or "why am I even trying" -- that's your answer. Turn it off. If you're watching and thinking "oh that's a good idea, I want to try that" -- keep watching.

It might change day to day and that's OK. Listen to your body.

LESSON 7

Block and mute without guilt

You're going to get rude people, trolls, and comments that throw you off. Don't let them.

Block them. Mute them. Don't engage, don't explain, don't feel bad about it. Your live is your space. Protecting your energy while you're building this skill is not optional -- it's necessary.

THAT'S IT

The only wrong move is not starting

Your first live -- or your next one -- doesn't need to be good. It needs to happen.

Pick a product you love. Set up your camera. Hit go. If you need to read a script word-for-word with no face on camera, do that. If you can show up face-forward and wing it, do that.

A year ago I was grading papers and counting down to summer. Now I work when I want, from where I want, doing something I actually enjoy. It started with one live that wasn't pretty. Yours can too.

Disclaimer: Everything in this guide is based on personal experience from over a year of live streaming on TikTok. None of this is set in stone. Different creators will tell you different things and many approaches can work. This is what's worked for me.

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